

Frame Maker and PageMaker are yet to incorporate this feature.

Styles: Who would want to take the trouble of formatting all the paragraphs in one particular style? With paragraph style sheets, one can load the predefined set of styles already provided by the software or save their own styles in case they are going to be used again. Professionals actually use this function to a great extent—all it needs is a click to format paragraphs by selecting the appropriate style. Similar to paragraph style sheets, character style sheets allow one to have a particular style of formatting attributes that can be applied to a selection of text. Thus, for example, for logos or for headlines, you can save such character styles once and then apply them wherever required by a single click.

PageMaker and Publisher are disappointing when it comes to styles—PageMaker provides for only character style sheets and Publisher provides only paragraph style sheets.

Importing text: One usually uses some office program or the other to make text documents and spreadsheets. Hence, if one wishes to import data into a page layout program, it should appear exactly the

way it was formatted—if one were to reformat the text after it's been imported into the page layout software, it would just be an unnecessary duplication of work.

PostScript Files

While working with page layout software, one often faces problems when sending the final documents to get printed at the press. One usually gets 'font missing' errors because the font used while designing the document may not be installed at the printer's end. To work around this, copy the fonts along with the documents so that they can be installed before the document is finally printed.

In 1985, Adobe developed PostScript which became an industry standard for printing and imaging. PostScript is basically a programming language which describes the appearance of the page containing text and graphics to the output device (colour or a black and white printer or any other output device).

To eliminate font-related problems, you can save your documents as Post-

Script files. This will save you from worrying about which platform or version of system software the service provider has.

PostScript files contain all the fonts used in the document so the fonts will appear correctly even if the output device does not have them. Files saved in the PostScript format can even be sent over the Internet to the service provider. However, the large file sizes associated with PostScript files deter many from sending documents over the Net, especially in India where bandwidth is a major problem.

To reduce the file size one can, depending on the settings provided by the software, omit images (which are usually saved in TIFF format) from the document. These TIFF images can be sent separately and incorporated into the PostScript file before printing.

Adobe PageMaker shines here as it can retain the formatting while importing text, though it does lose the font size. InDesign also does a good job of importing text